



Twitter testing new feature
Twitter is testing new feature to let users report misleading tweets.
<https://digit.in/sep21-17>



Buy movie tickets with bitcoin
AMC theaters, an American chain, will start accepting Bitcoin this year
<https://digit.in/sep21-18>

the freedom struggles of countries, including India. Newspapers started reaching every nook and corner, and while the governments went after the free voices that expressed themselves through newspapers, they could never shut them down.

When it comes to periodicals, the story is like newspapers, but these escaped censorship. The first time the magazines saw the light of day was way back in the 17th century. A German theologian and poet, Johann Rist, published the *Erbauliche Monats-Unterredungen*, or *Edifying Monthly Discussions*, this periodical lasted from 1663 to 1668. This short lived publication was responsible for popularising the concept of a periodical in Europe. In 1672, Jean Donneau de Vizé oversaw the publication and circulation of what can be called a “periodical of amusement”. An amalgamation of short stories, news and poetry, *Le Mercure Galant*, as it was called in its early years, before being renamed *Mercure de France*, gained a lot of readers amongst the educated class of society at the time.

The number of periodicals in print exploded in tandem with the increase in popularity and efficiency of the printing press in Europe. The printers and writers of the time laid the foundations of various periodicals as we know it today, by creating almanacks, pamphlets and brochures which had information with a longer shelf life as compared to the daily or weekly newspapers.

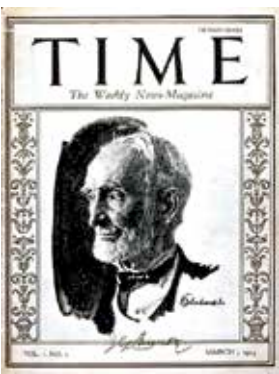
Periodicals had hit upon the perfect recipe, or what we now know as the content mix and were poised to explode into the public domain and become as widespread as they are today, retaining their core sensibilities even in the digital formats. The thing that stood in the way was the widespread illiteracy prevailing in society at the time. Apart from a select few, no one knew how to read and write, and even many of those who could found the the sophisticated language that these early publications were written in too obtuse for consumption.

In the 1700s, the general society started getting literate, was a necessary catalyst that brought about the explosion of periodicals in the societies. Women especially got more and more literate and became avid readers of this relatively newly found source of information and entertainment. Publishers stepped up to meet the demand, and one of the first periodicals that were published specifically for women cropped up in the year 1693, called the *Athenian Mercury*.

These periodicals that were becoming increasingly widespread, started getting called “magazines” for the first time in 1731. An English gentleman named Edward Cave is the one who is credited with coining the word, deriving it from an Arabic word *makhazin*, which meant storehouse. Cave launched a periodical called the *Gentleman’s Magazine*,



Athenian Mercury, published on February 28, 1693



The first issue of Time (March 3, 1923), featuring Speaker Joseph G. Cannon

putting to use the word he had coined.

On the other side of the world, in America, the first magazine began publishing in 1741 by Andrew Bradford. The initial attempts at printing and circulating magazines in America at the beginning were not successful, but they slowly became popular. As time passed, the magazines found their footing in American

society. By the end of the 18th century, there were around 100 magazines in publication in America.

In the year 1842, the first illustrated magazine as it is known to be, *The Illustrated London News*, was published by Hebert Ingram. Magazines, by this time, had started to become more and more focused on single subjects to cater to the specific requirements and sensibilities of their readers, and 1818 saw the *American Journal of Science* being founded. This is what set the foundation of scientific journals covering a special niche and catering to audiences with tailored interests. The *National Geographic* magazine which began publication in 1888 was one of the first specialised publications of the time, and became the benchmark for wildlife, science, geology, world events and nature publications worldwide, for the general public and not using the technical terms of those working in the field.

TIME magazine was first published in 1923. One of the most famous publications of the world till date, getting featured in the magazine remains as big an honour today as it is as it was back in the day. Many of the covers of both *National Geographic* and *Time* became memorable and iconic. Since, then there has been no looking back as magazines grew in circulation by attracting and growing readers around the kind of content that they published. 